

TAX FILING

Most of us will agree, filing taxes is a nightmare every tax season and people would be suddenly seen with less hair on their head and uneven fingernails. Not any more. There are a number of websites that help you file your income tax while cutting down on the hassle from the process. Here are the four websites that we found useful:

1 ClearTax: A website with a pleasant UI, ClearTax allows you two methods to provide your information – either you can enter manually or you can upload your Form 16 PDF and let the tool scan your details. All you would need to do is enter your PAN number, address and other profile details. If you are new to online tax filing, you can go through the useful guide section where the basics of tax filing are explained quite well. There is a paid option for ₹499 where CA's are available to do the entire filing for you over a few phone calls. But if you want 24/7 free support at the cost of paid Form-16 detection, try Taxsmile.

ClearTax: <http://dgit.in/ClearTax>

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2 H&R Block: While it also offers automatic detail scanning and an easy to use UI, the major difference for H&R Block are the "Agents Ready to Help" as an option even on the free tier. It also has premium options at ₹499 to have your filing checked and ₹999 to have your filing done by a CA. Compared to ClearTax, this is oriented towards slightly experienced users.

3 Taxspanner: Perhaps the costliest alternative compared to the other three, Taxspanner has no free tier and does not offer automatic Form-16 detection. Then why is it here? It's the best option for those who are actually looking for something more than copy pasting Form-16 details. The annual subscriptions for ₹1,499 offer CA support throughout the year for monitoring income to provide you tax efficient options. Somewhere between this and ClearTax is H&R Block that helps you get your filing checked or filed in its premium options.

Link: <http://dgit.in/HnRBlock>

but is very good at tracking, budgeting and providing detailed breakdown of all your transactions.

PAYMENT AGGREGATORS

Since the major e-commerce boom in India, one of the most significant changes in the way money is handled has been the rise of payment aggregators and digital payments. It has created a familiarity between people and internet banking and people are now willing to take care of most of their purchases, bookings and bills digitally. This has created the market for payment aggregators and the market is filling fast with options where some are good, and others, not so much. Some of the interesting payment aggregators have been covered here.

1 Your Bank's Mobile App: The mobile apps from most major Indian banks now have the ability to settle utility bills and do recharges within the apps itself. A major perk of using the mobile app of your own bank is that you don't have to trust any third party with your account credentials and authorisations go through very smoothly. Needless to say, options might be limited compared to dedicated aggregators.

2 Paytm: From one of the first independent online recharge options to being well on the way to becoming

India's spiritual equivalent of Paypal, Paytm's truly showed up on the map when it integrated with Uber as the only payment option. Paytm deals with utility bills as well as ticket bookings, but just like most other dedicated payment aggregators, suffers from a limited

number of states covered. With the largest user base, it is majorly known for the cashbacks it offers. Although it does cover most grounds, it still doesn't provide a card that can be used for payments. You can opt for Freecharge that has the option to avail a Freecharge Go MasterCard.

Link: <http://dgit.in/Paytmapp>

One of the major reasons to use payment aggregators is the reduced dependency on the bank as your sole money management institution. There's an increasing complication in the payment scenario online, with credit cards, debit cards, gift cards, online banking, payment gateways for your electricity bills, mobile bills, DTH bills, ticket bookings etc. A simplified payment aggregator that brings it all under one roof can help you save a lot of time.

Now that you have all these apps and web-tools at your disposal, pretty soon you should be saving a ton of money and suddenly turn into a financial guru, right? Unfortunately, technology still hasn't completely replaced the need for your actual intentions. With the right tools, you just need to have the actual intention of saving money rather than expecting the app to do it for you. Then, and only then, will you be rid of the woes of month-end and tax seasons. So get that smartphone out, roll those sleeves and get ready to save! 



At first glance, it almost looks like a business news channel in your pocket, but with a little stock know-how and some dabbling, it can prove to be very useful.